Question ID: de5a0001

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Central Ideas and Details	Easy

Question

When the town of Alder Creek closed its downtown parking lot in 2021, residents voted to turn the space into a community garden. Within two years the garden had forty plots, a waiting list, and a Saturday market where gardeners sold what they grew. Local shop owners, who had worried about losing parking, reported more customers on market days than before.

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

Answer

A. A parking lot was replaced by a garden that became popular and helped nearby shops.

B. Residents of Alder Creek disagreed about whether parking was needed downtown.

C. Gardeners in Alder Creek earned most of their income at the Saturday market.

D. Shop owners in Alder Creek asked the town to build a new parking lot.

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The text describes the lot becoming a garden, the garden filling up, and shops gaining customers. B, C and D each take one detail further than the text does.

Question ID: de5a0002

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Command of Evidence	Medium

Question

A librarian studied visits to three branches of a city library after the branches began opening on Sunday afternoons in 2022. She claims that Sunday hours increased visits at every branch, not only at the largest one.

Average Weekly Visits by Branch

Branch	2021	2023
Central	2,400	2,950
Riverside	860	1,140
Hillview	510	690

Which choice best uses data from the table to support the librarian's claim?

Answer

A. Central had more visits than Riverside and Hillview combined in 2021.

B. Weekly visits rose at Central, Riverside and Hillview between 2021 and 2023.

C. Hillview had the fewest weekly visits of the three branches in both years.

D. Riverside had fewer weekly visits than Central in 2023.

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. The claim is that visits rose at every branch, and B reports a rise at all three. A, C and D compare branches with each other instead of showing a change at each one.

Question ID: de5a0003

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Information and Ideas	Inferences	Medium

Question

Ecologist Mara Ilves recorded the songs of great tits in a city park and in a forest twenty kilometers away. City birds sang at a higher pitch than forest birds. When Ilves played recordings of traffic noise in the forest, forest birds also began singing higher, but only while the noise played. This suggests that the city birds' higher songs _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

Answer

A. are inherited and could not change within one bird's lifetime.

B. are a response to the noise around them rather than a fixed trait.

C. make city birds less likely to find mates than forest birds.

D. would become lower if the forest grew noisier over time.

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. Forest birds sang higher only while noise played, so pitch changes with the surroundings. A contradicts that result, and so does D: noise made the forest birds sing higher, so a noisier forest would raise their songs, not lower them. C is not supported by anything in the text.

Question ID: de5a0004

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Craft and Structure	Words in Context	Easy

Question

The architect designed the community center to be _____: its walls slide on tracks, so one large hall can become four classrooms in a few minutes.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

Answer

A. adaptable

B. ornate

C. temporary

D. isolated

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. As used in the text, "adaptable" means able to change to suit different uses. Walls that slide so one hall becomes four classrooms describe exactly that kind of building. Choice B is incorrect. "Ornate" means heavily decorated, and nothing in the text is about decoration. Choice C is incorrect. "Temporary" means lasting only a short time, and the text does not say the center will not last. Choice D is incorrect. "Isolated" means far away from other people or places, and the text says nothing about where the center is.

Question ID: de5a0005

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Craft and Structure	Text Structure and Purpose	Medium

Question

For decades, engineers assumed that a bridge's cables wear out mainly from the weight of traffic. A 2019 survey of twelve suspension bridges found that moisture inside the cables caused more damage than any load. Since then, several cities have added dry-air systems that blow air through their cables.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

Answer

A. It gives a finding that challenged an earlier assumption.

B. It describes the method engineers used to build early bridges.

C. It explains why traffic on suspension bridges has increased.

D. It lists the cities that have added dry-air systems.

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The first sentence states what engineers assumed; the underlined sentence reports a survey that found otherwise, and the last sentence describes what changed as a result.

Question ID: de5a0006

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Craft and Structure	Cross-Text Connections	Hard

Question

Text 1

Historian Lena Ortiz argues that the spread of cheap printed almanacs in the 1700s did more than any school to teach farm families to read, because almanacs were the one book nearly every household bought each year.

Text 2

Records from three rural counties show that almanacs were common, but many households that owned them also signed legal papers with a mark rather than a name. Owning a book, historian Paul Weng notes, is not the same as reading one.

Based on the texts, how would Weng (Text 2) most likely respond to Ortiz's argument (Text 1)?

Answer

A. He would agree, since the records show almanacs were widely owned.

B. He would question it, since owning almanacs does not show that people read them.

C. He would reject it, since almanacs were too expensive for most families.

D. He would add that schools taught reading using almanacs.

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. Weng accepts that almanacs were common but points out that owners often could not sign their names, which weakens the link Ortiz draws between owning almanacs and learning to read.

Question ID: de5a0007

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Rhetorical Synthesis	Medium

Question

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The Harlan Observatory opened in 1931.
- Its telescope was the largest in the state until 1968.
- It now runs free viewing nights twice a month.
- About 3,000 visitors attended viewing nights last year.

The student wants to emphasize how popular the observatory is today. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes?

Answer

A. The Harlan Observatory, which opened in 1931, once had the state's largest telescope.

B. About 3,000 visitors came to the Harlan Observatory's free viewing nights last year.

C. Until 1968, no telescope in the state was larger than the Harlan Observatory's.

D. The Harlan Observatory opened in 1931 and runs viewing nights twice a month.

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. It gives the attendance figure, which is what shows popularity today. A and C are about the past; D says how often the nights happen but not how many people come.

Question ID: de5a0008

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Transitions	Easy

Question

Many desert plants store water in thick leaves. _____ the jade plant can survive for weeks without rain by drawing on the water held in its leaves.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Answer

A. However,

B. For example,

C. Instead,

D. Meanwhile,

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. The jade plant is one example of a desert plant that stores water in its leaves, so the second sentence illustrates the first.

Question ID: de5a0009

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Expression of Ideas	Transitions	Medium

Question

Early electric cars of the 1900s were quiet and easy to start, and many drivers preferred them. _____ by the 1920s gasoline cars had taken over the market, because cheap fuel and longer driving ranges mattered more to buyers than quiet engines.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

Answer

A. Similarly,

B. In addition,

C. Nevertheless,

D. For instance,

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is the best answer. Electric cars were popular, yet gasoline cars won anyway; "Nevertheless" signals that contrast.

Question ID: de5a000a

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Boundaries	Easy

Question

The museum's newest exhibit features tools made by hand in the 1800s _____ visitors can try several of the tools themselves at a workbench near the exit.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

A. 1800s,

B. 1800s;

C. 1800s

D. 1800s; and

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. Two independent clauses are joined, and a semicolon can join them. A makes a comma splice, C a run-on, and D puts a semicolon before "and": a semicolon joins the clauses on its own, without a conjunction.

Question ID: de5a000b

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Form, Structure, and Sense	Medium

Question

The collection of letters written by the town's first mayor _____ now kept in a climate-controlled room at the county archive.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

A. are

B. is

C. were

D. have been

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is the best answer. The subject is "collection," which is singular, so the verb is "is." "Letters" belongs to a phrase that describes the collection and does not decide the verb.

Question ID: de5a000c

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Boundaries	Medium

Question

The recipe called for three ingredients that were hard to find in winter _____ fresh basil, ripe tomatoes, and soft goat cheese.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

A. winter:

B. winter;

C. winter, and

D. winter, those were

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. A colon introduces the list that names the three ingredients. A semicolon (B) would need a full clause after it, C makes the sentence ungrammatical, and D joins two clauses with only a comma.

Question ID: de5a000d

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in one variable	Easy

Question

$$3x + 7 = 22$$

What value of x is the solution to the given equation?

Answer

A. 3

B. 5

C. 7

D. 15

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. Subtracting 7 from both sides gives 3x = 15, and dividing by 3 gives x = 5.

Question ID: de5a000e

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Systems of two linear equations in two variables	Medium

Question

$$x + y = 10$$
$$x - y = 4$$

The solution to the given system of equations is (x, y). What is the value of x?

Answer

A. 3

B. 6

C. 7

D. 14

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. Adding the two equations gives 2x = 14, so x = 7 (and then y = 3).

Question ID: de5a000f

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear functions	Medium

Question

A line in the xy-plane passes through the points (0, 2) and (8, 8).

What is the slope of the line?

Correct Answer: 3/4, .75

Rationale

The correct answer is 3/4. The slope is the change in y over the change in x: (8 - 2) / (8 - 0) = 6/8 = 3/4. Note that 3/4 and .75 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Question ID: de5a0010

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Equivalent expressions	Easy

Question

Which expression is equivalent to $(x + 3)(x - 3)$?

Answer

A. $x^2 - 9$

B. $x^2 + 9$

C. $x^2 - 6x - 9$

D. $x^2 + 6x - 9$

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. Multiplying out gives $x^2 - 3x + 3x - 9$, and the middle terms cancel, leaving $x^2 - 9$.

Question ID: de5a0011

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear equations in one variable and systems of equations in two variables	Medium

Question

$$x^2 - 5x + 6 = 0$$

What is the sum of the solutions to the given equation?

Answer

A. 1

B. 5

C. 6

D. 11

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. The equation factors as (x - 2)(x - 3) = 0, so the solutions are 2 and 3, and their sum is 5.

Question ID: de5a0012

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear functions	Medium

Question

The function f is defined by the equation below.

$$f(x) = x^2 - 6x + 11$$

What is the minimum value of f(x)?

Answer

A. 2

B. 3

C. 6

D. 11

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. Completing the square gives $f(x) = (x - 3)^2 + 2$. The squared term is never negative, so the least value is 2, at $x = 3$.

Question ID: de5a0013

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Ratios, rates, proportional relationships, and units	Easy

Question

A cyclist rides 12.6 kilometers in 3 hours at a constant speed.

What is the cyclist's speed, in kilometers per hour?

Correct Answer: 4.2, 21/5

Rationale

The correct answer is 4.2. Speed is distance divided by time: 12.6 / 3 = 4.2 kilometers per hour. Note that 4.2 and 21/5 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Question ID: de5a0014

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Percentages	Medium

Question

A jacket that normally costs $80 is on sale for 15% off.

What is the sale price of the jacket, in dollars?

Answer

A. 65

B. 68

C. 72

D. 95

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. 15% of 80 is 12, and 80 - 12 = 68.

Question ID: de5a0015

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	One-variable data: Distributions and measures of center and spread	Easy

Question

The table shows how many books each of five students read over the summer.

Books Read Over the Summer

Student	Books
Ana	4
Ben	7
Chloe	7
Dev	9
Eli	13

What is the mean number of books read by the five students?

Answer

A. 7

B. 8

C. 9

D. 40

Correct Answer: B

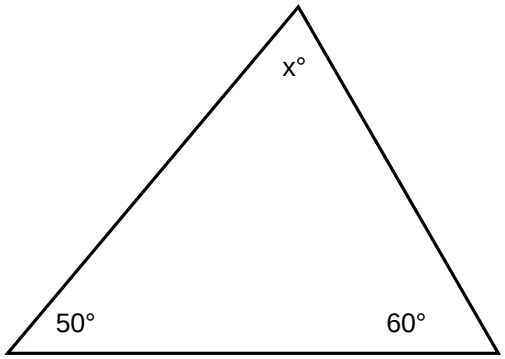
Rationale

Choice B is correct. The total is 4 + 7 + 7 + 9 + 13 = 40, and 40 / 5 = 8. Choice A is the median, and choice D is the total.

Question ID: de5a0016

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Lines, angles, and triangles	Medium

Question



In the triangle shown, what is the value of x?

Answer

A. 50

B. 60

C. 70

D. 110

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. The angles of a triangle add to 180°, so x = 180 - 50 - 60 = 70.

Question ID: de5a0017

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Area and volume	Easy

Question

A rectangular box is 3 inches wide, 4 inches long, and 5 inches tall.

What is the volume of the box, in cubic inches?

Answer

A. 12

B. 20

C. 47

D. 60

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. Volume is width times length times height: $3 \times 4 \times 5 = 60$ cubic inches.

Question ID: de5a0018

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Circles	Easy

Question

A circle in the xy-plane has the equation below.

$$(x - 2)^2 + (y + 1)^2 = 25$$

What is the radius of the circle?

Answer

A. 2

B. 5

C. 12.5

D. 25

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. In the form $(x - h)^2 + (y - k)^2 = r^2$, the right side is r^2, so $r^2 = 25$ and $r = 5$.